Introduction and overview

Computational modeling of language
Linguistics C189 / Cognitive Science C133
Spring 2026

A little bureaucracy

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- **In case of illness**: Please stay home and get better - we will accommodate!
- **Today**: Brief introduction, then the theme of the class, then nuts and bolts.

A little bureaucracy

- **Prerequisites**: Ling 100 and proficiency in programming in Python.
  - If you do not have these prerequisites, please **do not take the class**.

A little bureaucracy

- **No class meeting this Thursday.**

The plan for today

- Purpose of the class
- Introductions
- Brief overview of relevant history
- Nuts and bolts

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- Introduction to computational principles in the study of language.
- For linguists and cognitive scientists: cross-cuts different areas of linguistics.
- Not an NLP class! But there is some overlap. Focus on scientific questions.

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Association for Computational Linguistics

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Association for Computational Linguistics

Meet the team

Terry Regier
Instructor

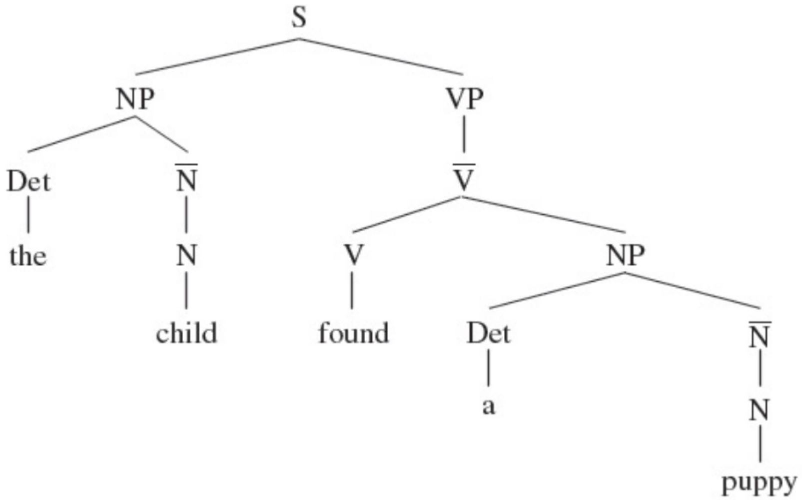
Inigo Parra
TA

Introduce yourself!

- Briefly say a few words about yourself:
  - Your major and background
  - What you hope to learn in this class

Brief overview of relevant history

Linguistics and computation share **deep roots**.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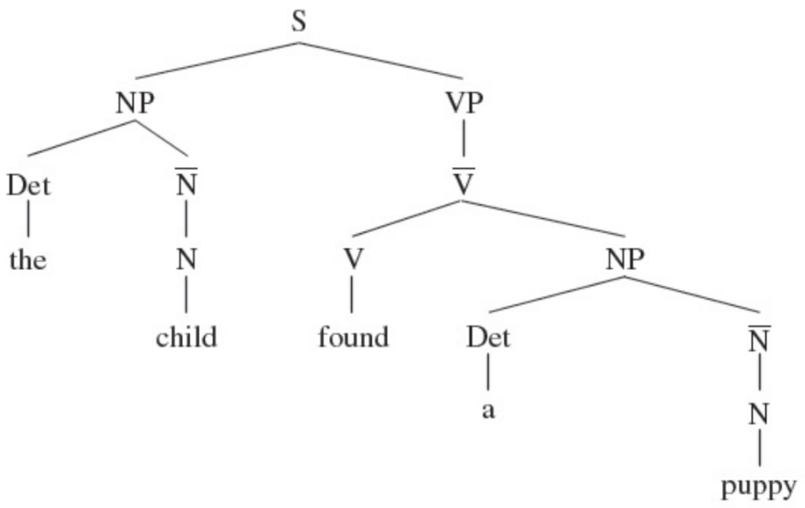
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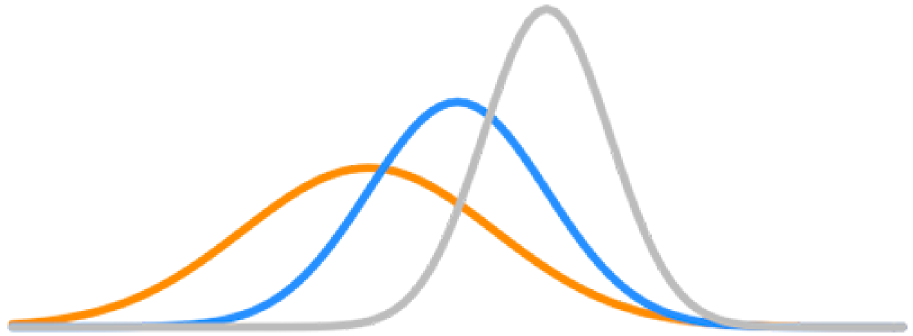

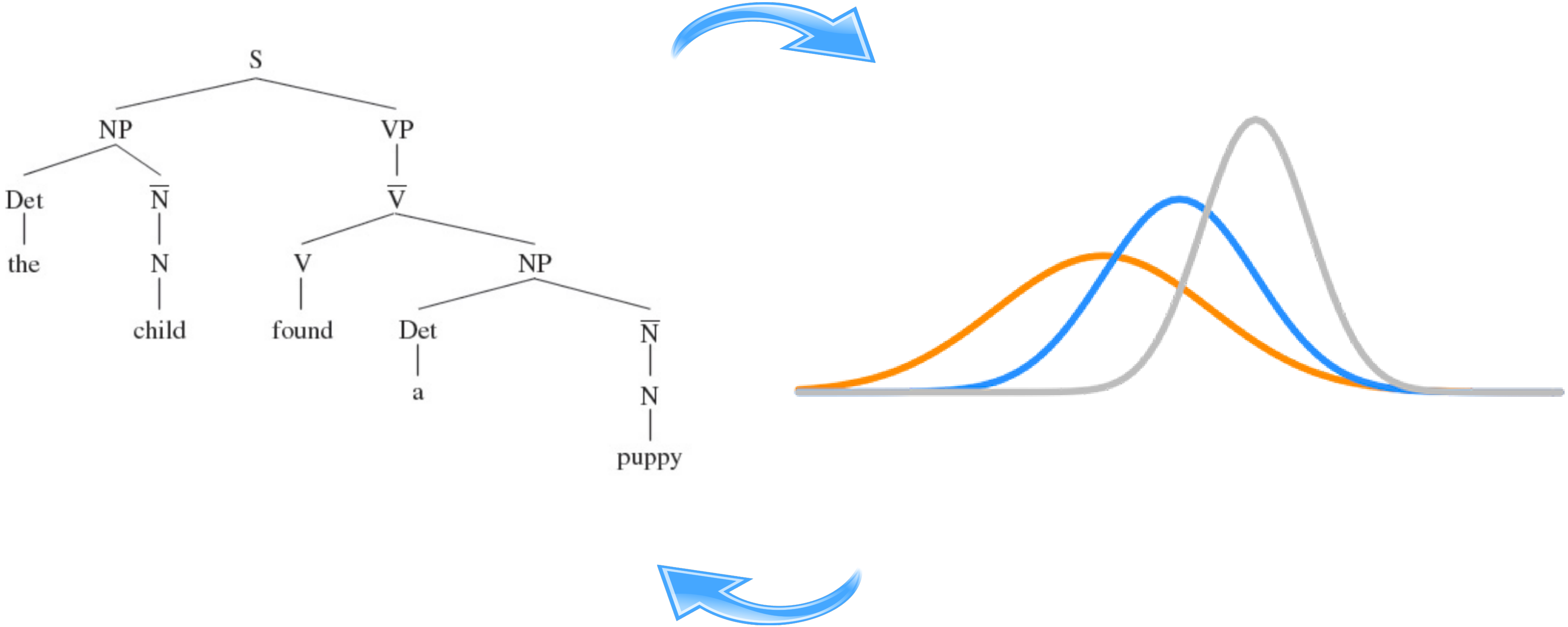
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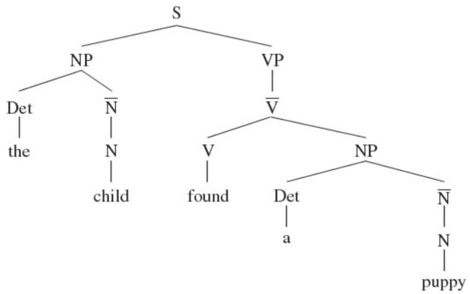

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- 1913: Markov chains, and application to Pushkin's poetry
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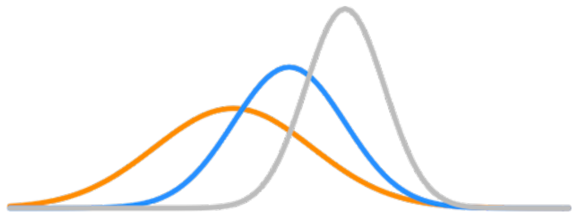

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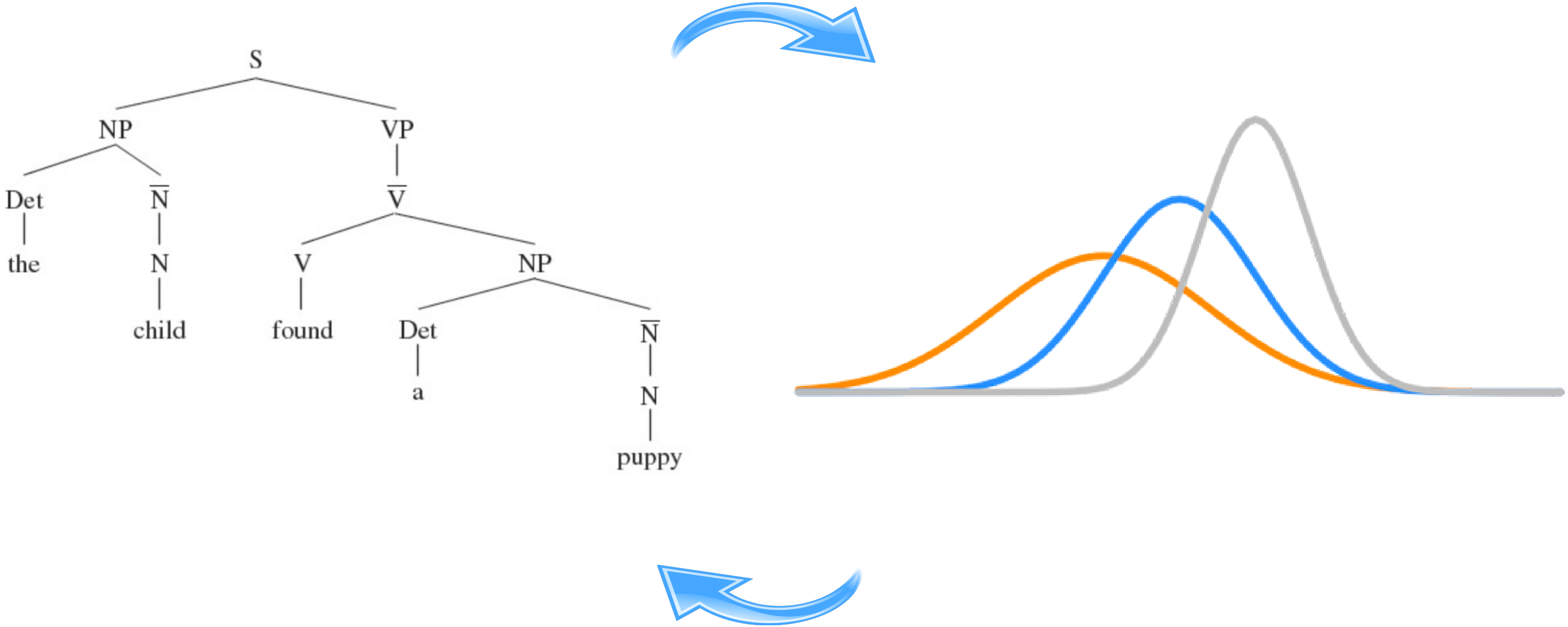
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Nuts and bolts

- Syllabus
- bCourses site
- Test homework on datahub